November 2026
Keep a copy on the jobsite during installation

Trim and Moulding Installation Guide

Trim boards, sheets, corners, mouldings, beadboard and soffit

Green Atlantic PVC is a premium PVC sealed edge trim made to install with the tools and habits of a finish carpenter. It cuts, routes and fastens like wood, but it is not wood: it moves with temperature, and that movement is what this guide is mostly about. Follow these instructions, Intertek Code Compliance Research Report CCRR-0420 and your local building code. Where this guide and CCRR-0420 conflict, CCRR-0420 governs.

> **The five rules that prevent almost every callback**
> 1. Screw and plug 3/4" to 1 1/4" trim boards and sheets with the Starborn Pro Plug System for PVC. Nails only tack them in place. 2. Fasten into framing or solid backing, never into sheathing alone. 3. Glue every scarf and miter with PVC cement. 4. Fasten long pieces fully, from the center out, so the board cannot walk. 5. Never paint white trim a dark color (LRV below 55).

1. Approved uses

Under CCRR-0420, Green Atlantic PVC is evaluated as nonload-bearing exterior trim for corner boards, soffit, fascia, battens, door pilasters, frieze boards, nonload-bearing rake boards, architectural millwork, and door and window trim. It may be used on all buildings permitted under the IRC, on Type V-B construction under the IBC, and as combustible architectural trim on Type I through IV buildings within the limits in CCRR-0420 Section 6.2.

Do not use Green Atlantic PVC for structural or load-bearing members, in direct ground contact, or where it will sit in standing water.

2. Storage and handling

- Store bundles flat on a level surface, supported every 2 feet or less, so long pieces do not take a set.
- Keep material out of prolonged direct sun until it is installed, and away from heat sources. Covering bundles with a light-colored tarp is fine; black plastic is not.
- Leave the protective film on until installation. Pull it before or immediately after the piece goes up; film left on in the sun becomes hard to remove.
- Carry long boards on edge, or with two people, so they do not whip and crack at cold temperatures.

3. Cutting, milling and routing

- Use carbide-tipped woodworking blades and bits. A blade with more teeth gives a cleaner cut.
- Run a slower feed rate than in wood. Too fast a feed heats the cut and can re-weld the chip to the edge.
- Green Atlantic boards can be ripped, routed, milled and shaped on site. A ripped or milled edge does not have the factory sealed surface and will pick up dirt more readily, so place cut edges where they are least exposed, or paint them.

- Lightly sand or scrape any cut edge that will show to remove burrs.

4. Fasteners

Which fastener you use depends on the thickness of the material:

Material	Fasten with
Trim boards, sheets and folded corner boards 3/4" to 1 1/4" thick	**Starborn Pro Plug System for PVC trim:** screws set with the Pro Plug PVC Tool and finished with matching plugs. Nails may be used only to tack a piece in place before it is screwed.
Sheets, soffit and beadboard thinner than 3/4", and all mouldings	Trim nails meeting the requirements below.
Extruded corners	Fasten through the integrated nailing flange with trim nails meeting the requirements below. Never fasten through the face.

Nailing 3/4" to 1 1/4" boards and sheets voids the warranty

Trim boards, sheets and folded corners 3/4" to 1 1/4" thick must be screwed and plugged with the Starborn Pro Plug System. Nails alone do not hold thick PVC against seasonal movement and are not covered by the Green Atlantic Limited Warranty.

Screws: Starborn Pro Plug System

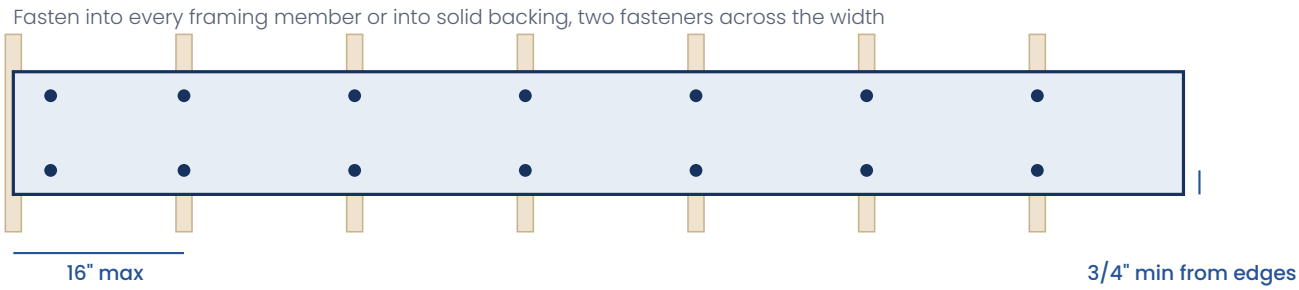
- Use Starborn Pro Plug System screws with a length that penetrates at least 1 1/2" into framing or solid wood backing.
- Stainless steel screws are recommended because they tolerate the movement of PVC best. Within sight of salt water, or where salt air or pool chemicals are present, use Marine Grade 316 stainless.
- Drive screws with the Pro Plug PVC Tool in a standard drill so each screw sets to the correct depth for the plug. Impact drivers may overdrive.
- Tap the matching plug into each hole and finish as Starborn directs. Follow Starborn's instructions for the system.

Nails: thinner material and mouldings

Requirement	Specification
Material	Stainless steel, or hot-dipped galvanized steel designed for wood trim and siding
Point and head	Blunt point and full round head
Length	Long enough to penetrate the wood substrate at least 1 1/2"
Corrosion protection	Suitable for exterior use and for the substrate. In preservative- or fire-retardant-treated wood, apply the treated-wood manufacturer's fastener adjustment factors
Not acceptable	Adhesive alone without mechanical fasteners; electro-galvanized or uncoated fasteners

Code note. Intertek CCRR-0420 evaluates nailed installation. Screw-and-plug fastening is outside the scope of that evaluation, so where code approval is required, confirm acceptance with your building official.

5. Fastening pattern



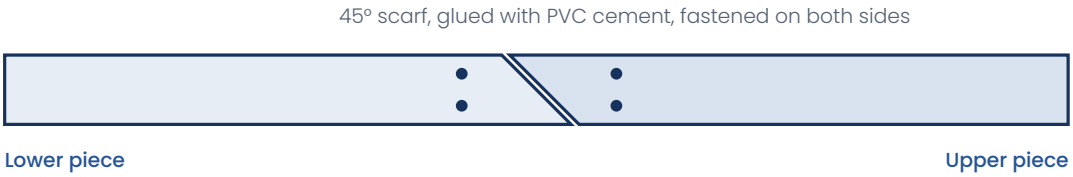
- Install trim over solid backing: approved exterior sheathing or exterior wall covering, and fasten into framing wherever framing is available.
- Space fasteners no more than 16" apart along the length.
- On boards 4" and wider, use two fasteners across the width at each location. On narrow boards, one fastener at each location is enough.
- Keep fasteners at least 3/4" from edges and 1" from ends. When nailing, predrill near an end or when the material is below about 40°F.
- Fasten from the center of the piece toward the ends. On long runs, every fastener location must be filled; a partly fastened board will move.
- Let the Pro Plug PVC Tool set screw depth. Set nail heads flush or just below the surface; do not overdrive.

6. Expansion and contraction

PVC moves with temperature, and it moves along its length far more than across its width. An 18' board gains or loses length every time the temperature swings. Joints stay tight when the pieces are fully fastened and the joints are glued, so the movement is held at each fastener instead of collecting at one gap.

- **Glue every scarf and miter joint** with a PVC cement (solvent weld). Glue the joint, not the back of the board to the wall.
- **Butt joints** that are not glued: when installing in cold weather, leave a small gap that will close as the material warms, about 1/8" per 18' of run below 40°F. In warm weather, fit butt joints snug.
- **Runs longer than 24 feet** need an expansion joint. Use a glued 45° scarf joint with a fastener on each side, or break the run at a corner or a piece of trim.
- **Dark and black PVC** absorbs more sun and runs hotter than white. Fastening and joint gluing matter more on black, not less.
- **Avoid concentrated reflected sun.** Sunlight reflected from energy-efficient (Low-E) windows on a neighboring wall can overheat and distort any trim. Where that reflection falls on trim, address it at the window.

7. Joints



- **Scarf joints.** Cut both pieces at 45°. Lap them so the upper piece covers the lower piece and sheds water away from the joint. Glue with PVC cement and fasten through both pieces near the joint.
- **Miters.** Glue every outside miter with PVC cement, then fasten through the miter. On wide casings, a biscuit or spline holds the miter in line while the cement cures.
- **Sealants.** Where trim meets other materials, use a high-quality exterior sealant compatible with PVC, such as a urethane or a polymer sealant made for PVC trim. Do not use silicone where the joint will be painted.

8. By application

Window and door trim

- Screw and plug casings 3/4" and thicker. Install over solid backing and integrate with the window or door flashing and the weather-resistive barrier according to the window or door manufacturer's instructions.
- Over new-construction windows with a nailing fin, use our trim rabbeted for the nailing fin so the casing sits flat without shimming or cutting the fin.
- Provide head flashing or a drip cap above heads so water is shed away from the top of the casing.

Corner boards

- **Folded corners** come glued from a single sheet in 20' lengths. Screw and plug both legs into framing following the fastening pattern above.
- **Extruded corners** fasten through the integrated nailing flange into framing. Seat the siding into the siding pocket, and follow the siding manufacturer's instructions for gaps at the pocket.
- **45° and inside corners** install the same way; fasten through the flanges, never through the face of the extrusion.

Fascia, frieze, rake and water table

- Install fascia over an approved structural sub-fascia, as CCRR-0420 requires, and screw and plug it with the Pro Plug System.
- Use notched fascia and frieze boards where soffit tucks behind them.
- Rake boards are nonload-bearing trim only; they must not carry roof loads.
- Flash above water table, frieze and any horizontal trim that can collect water.

Soffit

CCRR-0420 Section 4.4 rates soffit made of 1/2" x 11 1/4" boards on framing at 16" on center for 25 psf of negative (suction) wind pressure, fastened with two 8d finish nails (2 1/2" long) into each framing member, 3/4" from each board edge. Where design wind loads are higher, consult the code official.

- Use vented soffit where the roof assembly needs intake ventilation, and keep vents clear.

Beadboard ceilings and wainscot

- Install over framing or strapping at 12" on center, or over a solid plywood or OSB underlayment, and nail every 12" through the tongue or Stealth leg into wood.
- Leave a 1/4" gap at every wall, covered by moulding, and glue end joints with PVC cement.
- Full step-by-step instructions are in the Green Atlantic Beadboard Installation Guide.

Mouldings

- Fasten crown, bed and other mouldings into solid blocking or framing, not into the PVC trim behind them alone.
- Glue miters and copes with PVC cement. Long mouldings follow the same expansion rules as boards.
- Sills and sill noses are installed with a slope that sheds water away from the building.

9. Filling and painting

- Finish screw holes with the matching Starborn plugs. Fill nail holes with a filler made for PVC, not wood filler, strike off flush and let it cure before painting.
- **White PVC** needs no paint. If you paint it, clean the surface first and use a 100% acrylic latex exterior paint with a light reflective value (LRV) of 55 or higher. Darker colors void the warranty.
- **Black PVC** needs no paint. To repaint it, use a heat-reflective paint formulated for vinyl and PVC in a matching black.

10. Cleaning

Wash with mild dish soap and water, a soft cloth or a nylon brush. A melamine sponge removes most scuffs. Do not use abrasive cleaners, solvents such as acetone or paint thinner, or a high-pressure washer. Black PVC within five miles of a coastline should be rinsed with fresh water at least twice a year. Full care requirements are in the Green Atlantic Limited Warranty and Care Guide.

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CAD drawings, the full CCRR-0420 report, the product catalog and the limited warranty are available at greenatlanticpvc.com.